As a strictly cold-season vegetable, the rutabaga stores up lots of starch in the edible root base. It is this that gives this rich, wintry soup its velvety texture.

creamy rutabaga soup

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 40–50 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
BEFORE CREAM IS ADDED

2 tbsp butter
2 medium onions, chopped
1lb 10oz (750g) rutabaga (trimmed weight), cut into cubes
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 quart (1 liter) hot vegetable stock
1 tbsp honey
½ nutmeg (to grate)
⅔ cup half-and-half, plus extra to garnish

1 Melt the butter in a large pan over medium heat. Add the onions and cook for 6–8 minutes or until lightly golden. Stir in the rutabaga and a pinch of salt, cover with a lid, and cook for 10 minutes, stirring frequently. Pour in the stock, add the honey, and bring to a boil, grating in a bit of the nutmeg as you do so. Simmer for 20–30 minutes or until the rutabaga is completely soft.

2 Cool briefly, then process in a blender until smooth and velvety. You may need to do this in batches. Season with salt and freshly ground black pepper, then stir in the half-and-half. Serve each bowlful with a swirl of the half-and-half and a good grinding of black pepper.



RUTABAGA
Pick out rutabaga that are heavy for their size, but not too large—small generally equals sweet. They should be firm with an unblemished skin. Avoid any with shriveled roots. Store in a cool dark place for up to a week.